

SCORE
B O A R D Specifications

A Look at the Browsers										
	The Internet Communication Suites					Functional Browsers				
	Internet Explorer 6	Mozilla 0.9.3	NeoPlanet 5.2	Netscape 4.78	Netscape 6.1	K-Meleon 0.4	MSN Explorer	Netcaptor 6.5	Opera 5.12	Web Hunter Power Browser 5
Website	www.microsoft.com/windows/ie/	www.mozilla.org	www.neoplanet.com	http://home.netscape.com	http://home.netscape.com	www.kmeleon.org	http://explorer.msn.com/home.htm	www.netcaptor.com	www.opera.com	www.web-hunter.com
Installation size	160 MB	19 MB	9 MB	40 MB	40 MB	8 MB	21 MB	1.5 MB	36 MB	4 MB
Memory Consumed	14.6 MB	27.7 MB	23.5 MB	23 MB	28.9 MB	22 MB	25.3MB	16.0 MB	14.5 MB	21.8 MB
License Type	Freeware	Freeware	Freeware	Freeware	Freeware	Freeware	Freeware	Shareware	Adware	Freeware
iBench Scores *	53.74	136.46	153.37	111.16	141.68	147.34	54.35	56.6	67.14	54.77
CaffeineMark Scores	18484.3	Failed	18510	8240	9145.3	Failed	18314.3	18344.3	9388.3	18320
Email Client	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes (Hotmail Offline Backup)	No	Yes	No
Instant Messenger	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	No	Yes	No
HTML Editor	No	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No	No
Skinable	No	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes	No
Rating	A-	A-	B+	A-	A	B	B+	A-	A	B
* Lower scores indicate better performance										

MSN Explorer only have to key in the name of the Web site while accessing any site.

Considering that not many features are bundled with these browsers, they are really small in size. NetCaptor is the lightest, occupying just 1.5 MB hard disk space. Opera and MSN Explorer occupy the most hard disk space. Even though they require Internet Explorer to be already installed in your computer, MSN Explorer takes an additional 21 MB of hard disk space whereas Opera takes 39 MB.

Since these browsers have a comparatively small installation size, you would obviously expect them to load quickly. And they don't disappoint you on this front, with the exception of MSN Explorer. Anything less than 128 MB of RAM is not good enough for running this browser as it loads up a lot of graphics, which take up considerably more resources than Internet Explorer.

The goodies

If quick and efficient browsing is what you are looking for, and you are tired of opening a new window for every Web page, then Opera 5.12, NetCaptor and Web Hunter Power browser are what you

should be looking at. All three allow you to browse multiple sites in the very same window, similar to the multi-document view of Adobe Photoshop or other such applications that let you edit multiple documents in the same window.

NetCaptor also allows you to create a single bookmark for a group of sites (Captor groups) that you frequently visit, and with a single click, load up that whole category simultaneously. The ability to group similar sites, such as news sites or entertainment sites or search engines, and open them together can help you to better organise your online activities.

As far those annoying automatic pop up windows go, both Opera and NetCaptor save you the irritation by not displaying these windows.



NetCaptor offers multiple browsing capability

Opera was the only browser in this category that had its own light HTML rendering engine. Though very fast and efficient, it renders Web pages in a slightly different manner; they look a bit cramped when compared to other browsers. It uses the Java plugin from Sun to render the pages.

Web Hunter Power browser offered some curious features that had little practical use. For instance, the Spell Checker option wherein you can check spellings on the Web page you are viewing, or the facility to add a 3D border to the browser window, use flat scroll bars, etc. The Auto Complete feature in this browser does not perform the usual task of completing login names and passwords. Instead, it refers to a set of words already added in a list; in case your word matches with one from the dictionary, it is displayed for selection. **Screening for security:** Security is where most of these browsers were found lacking. Except for MSN Explorer and Opera, none of the browsers provide you with high encryption. NetCaptor and Web Hunter use Internet Explorer to open Web pages that support 128-bit encryption, whereas K-Meleon, which uses Netscape's Gecko engine, cannot open them at all.

Nor do they include within themselves